James Gillett

Conductor • Coach • Répétiteur



Location:
Manchester, UK
Website:
jamesgillett.co.uk

Education

The Royal Northern College of Music
MMus (dist.) in Répétiteur Studies, 2023

Continuing Professional Development, 2024

The University of Manchester
MusB (First Class), 2019

LRSM, Clarinet
ATCL, Piano (dist.)

Teachers:
Nico de Villiers
Martin Pickard
Kevin Thraves
Roger Hamilton (continuo)
Mark Heron (conducting)

Current Positions

2025–: **Keele Philharmonic Ensembles** • Musical Director
2024–: **Royal Northern College of Music** • freelance staff accompanist
2023–: Freelance répétiteur and coach
2023–: **Voices in Achord**, acapella choir • Musical Director
2021–: **Oldham Symphony Orchestra** • Musical Director

A full list of performed operatic and orchestral repertoire can be found at:
www.jamesgillett.co.uk/#Repertoire

Conductor / Musical Director

Aug 2026	**PB Theatricals** • musical director
Nov 2026	**Crosby Symphony Orchestra** • guest conductor
May 2027	**Alderley Edge Symphony Orchestra** • guest conductor
July 2027	**Wirral Symphony Orchestra** • guest conductor
Mar 2026	**Oldham Symphony Orchestra & Massed Chorus** • conductor Handel, *Messiah*
Feb 2026	**RNCM** at Didsbury Coffee Concerts • conductor Ravel, *Shéhérazade* (arr. Paolo Fradiani)
Nov 2025	**Crosby Symphony Orchestra** • guest conductor
Oct 2025	**Opera Vera** • musical director
2024–2025	**PB Theatricals** • MD / conductor Gilbert & Sullivan works
Nov 2024	**Random Opera** • MD and performance pianist Mozart, *Don Giovanni*
June 2024	**Flat Pack Music** • MD and performance pianist Mozart, *The Marriage of Figaro* (in English)
March 2023	**RNCM** student-led opera double bill • MD, repetiteur and pianist Barber, *A Hand of Bridge* Menotti, *The Telephone*
August 2021	**Waterperry Opera Festival** • Young Artist Conductor Assistant conductor for Donizetti, *The Elixir of Love* MD/conductor for Young Artist Scenes
2021	**Manchester Contemporary Youth Opera** at Tête-à-Tête
2020	**The University of Manchester** • MD / coach Dove, *The Enchanted Pig*
2019	**Manchester Contemporary Youth Opera** • MD / conductor
2019	**The Goya Project** • MD and Producer Stravinsky, *The Soldier's Tale* Raised over £3,000 for The Royal British Legion

Répétiteur / Orchestral Piano

July 2026	**Clyde Opera** • repetiteur, Puccini, *La Bohéme*
July 2025	**English National Opera** • Repetiteur for outreach performances
2023–2025	**RNCM Community Chorus** • Repetiteur and accompanist
2023, 2024	**PB Theatricals** • Repetiteur and performance pianist Gilbert & Sullivan works
May 2024	**Streetwise Opera** • Ad-hoc repetiteur
August 2023	**Cumbria Opera Festival**: accompanist for masterclass with Joan Rogers ad hoc repetiteur for Mozart, *Don Giovanni*

References

Contact details are available upon request

Répétiteur / Orchestral Piano (cont.)

2022–2023	**RNCM Opera Scenes** • Repetiteur and pianist
Oct 2022	**BBC Philharmonic** • Anna Appleby, *Drought* World Premiere: repetiteur and coach
March 2022	**RNCM Opera** • Mozart, *Le Nozze di Figaro* Fortepiano continuo player Choreography pianist
Dec 2021	**RNCM Opera** • Strauss, *Ariadne auf Naxos* (Prologue) • Orchestral pianist

Concerts

2027	**Grimsby Concert Society**, Evening opera and song recital
2026	**Grimsby Concert Society**, Evening opera and song recital
2024–25	**Manchester Cathedral**, Lunchtime song recitals

Masterclasses / private studios

Quentin Hayes	Baritone
Yvonne Howard	Mezzo-Soprano
Ann Murray	Mezzo-Soprano
Linda Richardson	Soprano
Joan Rogers	Soprano
Hilary Summers	Contralto

Awards

- **Gwendolyn Reiche Memorial Scholarship**, 2021 and 2022
- **The University of Manchester**, Hargreaves Prize for Analysis, 2020
- **Society for Musical Analysis** Undergraduate Award, “Highly Commended”, 2020

Other

- A2 level German (**Goethe Institute**)
- Working knowledge of theatre roles and departments
- Member of the Independent Society of Musicians (**ISM**)
- Enhanced check from UK Disclosure and Barring Service for Child Workforce (under 18s)